Workspace requirements

SMBC Data & AI Workshop · 22 October 2026

An extract from the SMBC Data & AI Workshop guide (section 3), for the SAG team and workspace administrators.

3. Workspace requirements: what must be enabled

> **For the SAG team and workspace administrators.** Each item explains why the workshop needs it, where the setting lives, and its default. Please confirm by **Tuesday 20 October** so the smoke tests in 3.8 can run on an SMBC laptop before the day. Setting names and paths are from the Azure Databricks documentation as of October 2026.

Already confirmed: the workshop uses a new, dedicated workspace with **serverless compute enabled**, and **Genie has no question-rate limit** to plan around. The **SAG team owns the cross-Geo processing setting** (item 5).

No groups are needed. The setup shares everything with the workspace's built-in `users` group (everyone in the workspace) and recognises facilitators by email. Attendees need access to the `smbc_workshop` catalog (3.6) and to a SQL warehouse (3.4).

3.1 Checklist

#	Requirement	Why the workshop needs it	Where it's set	Who	Default	Status
1	Unity Catalog metastore attached to the workspace	Everything: Designer, Genie Agents, lineage	Account console	Account admin	New workspaces are usually enabled automatically	☐
2	Serverless compute	Designer, notebooks, Jobs, Genie Code	Already enabled	Workspace admin		✅
3	A pro or serverless **SQL warehouse** that attendees can use	Dashboards, Genie Agents, SQL editor	Any existing warehouse, for example the Serverless Starter Warehouse (3.4)	Workspace admin		☐
4	**Partner-powered AI features** on, for the account *and* the workspace	Genie Agents, chat in Genie One, Genie Code's agentic features (including Designer's natural-language prompts), AI-assisted dashboard charts	3.2 and 3.3	Account admin, workspace admin	On (off for workspaces with the compliance security profile)	☐
5	**Cross-Geo processing** allowed	In the Asia Pacific Geo: Genie Agents (chat and agent mode), chat in Genie One, Genie Code's agentic features	3.2	Account admin (**SAG team**)	Allowed for workspaces outside the US and EU without the compliance security profile	☐
6	Excel file support	Dragging the limits spreadsheet onto the Designer canvas	Smoke test 5; if it fails, check the workspace **Previews** page	Workspace admin		☐

#	Requirement	Why the workshop needs it	Where it's set	Who	Default	Status
7	Attendees can sign in, with **Workspace access** and **Databricks SQL access**; no groups needed	Signing in and building	3.5	Workspace admin	On for workspace users	□
8	One test user with **Consumer access** only	Showing the business-user view in Genie One	3.5	Workspace admin		□
9	The `smbc_workshop` catalog, and attendee access to it	The labs	The setup notebook (section 4), then the grants in 3.6	Catalog owner or metastore admin		□
10	Access from SMBC laptops on the venue network	Everything	3.7	SMBC network team		□
11	*(Optional)* Delivery of dashboard subscription emails to SMBC addresses	A Lab 2 stretch exercise	SMBC mail gateway	SMBC messaging team		□

3.2 Account-level settings (account admin)

Partner-powered AI features: on. Genie Agents, chat in Genie One, Genie Code's agentic capabilities and AI-assisted dashboard charts are only available with this setting on. When it is off, Genie Code still works without its agentic capabilities, using a Databricks-hosted model.

1. In the account console, click **Settings**.
2. Open the **Feature enablement** tab.
3. Set **Enable partner-powered AI features** to **On**. Use **Enforce** only if workspaces must not override it.

Enabling or disabling this setting is recorded as an account event in the audit logs.

Cross-Geo processing: allowed *(owner: SAG team)*. Some AI features are "Designated Services" that use Azure Geographies to manage data residency. In the **Asia Pacific Geo**, which includes Southeast Asia (Singapore), the features this workshop uses for Genie need cross-Geo processing (see 3.9).

1. In the account console sidebar, click **Workspaces** and open the workshop workspace.
2. Open the **Security and compliance** tab.
3. Make sure **Enforce data processing within workspace Geography for Designated Services** is **disabled**. Some pages call it *Enforce data processing within workspace Geography for AI features*.

The documentation says: "*your data is not stored outside of your workspace's Geo regardless of this setting.*" Cross-Geo processing is enabled by default for workspaces outside the US and EU that don't use the compliance security profile, so this is usually a check rather than a change. Preview features also follow this setting.

Account-level Genie One: optional. The workshop uses the workspace-level Genie One (`<workspace URL>/one`), so account-level Genie One isn't required. If you review it: Databricks-generated metadata for account-level Genie One (asset identifiers, usage signals, audit events) might be processed in the US. An account admin can turn it off under **Settings** → **Feature enablement** → **Genie** without affecting workspace-level Genie One.

Compliance security profile. If the workspace uses the compliance security profile, partner-powered AI features are off by default and need an explicit decision.

3.3 Workspace-level settings (workspace admin)

- **Partner-powered AI features: on.** Go to your username → **Settings** → **Workspace admin** → **Advanced** → **Partner-powered AI features**. It inherits the account setting unless the account enforces it.
- **Previews:** none are required. Optionally turn on **Genie Agents Flash Mode** (Beta), a faster agent-mode option. Outside the US and EU it also needs cross-Geo processing.
- **Genie One homepage (optional, recommended),** so the business-user view feels finished when it's shown. This is set in the UI only, after `06_deploy_dashboards_and_agents` has run:
  1. Go to your username → **Settings** → **Appearance**, and next to **Genie One home page** click **Edit**.
  2. Paste the welcome message below into **Markdown text**. Optionally set a brand colour and upload a logo.
  3. Turn on **Pinned content enabled**, click **Edit pinned assets**, and pin the reference dashboard and the reference Genie Agent. Click **Save**.

Welcome message for the Genie One homepage:

```
## Welcome to the SMBC Data & AI Workshop
Start with the **Credit Committee: APAC exposure** dashboard, or ask the **Credit Risk** Genie Agent a
question in plain English.

*All data in this workspace is synthetic: the borrowers, groups and figures are made up.*
```

3.4 Compute

Item	Recommendation
SQL warehouse	Any pro or serverless SQL warehouse that attendees can use (**CAN USE**), for example the workspace's **Serverless Starter Warehouse**. The setup uses the one you name, or picks the first one you can use, and prints its name: give that name to attendees. For about 40–60 people, a Small or Medium serverless warehouse with up to 4 clusters is comfortable; if you manage it, set a longer auto-stop on the day. Genie Agents need pro or serverless; serverless is recommended.
Serverless compute for notebooks, Jobs and Designer	Already on. Check that a test attendee can pick **Serverless** in Designer's compute picker; Designer needs CAN USE on at least one compute resource.

3.5 Identity and entitlements

Who	Entitlements	Notes
Attendees (any workspace users: no group is needed)	**Workspace access** and **Databricks SQL access** (on for workspace users by default)	Databricks SQL access is required to create Genie Agents and dashboards; workspace access is required for Designer and notebooks.
Facilitators	Workspace admin (recommended)	Run the setup notebooks and the governance demo. List the other facilitators' emails in the setup's `facilitator_emails` setting: they get full access to the catalog, see every branch in the governance demo, and can edit the reference dashboards and Genie Agents.
Genie One demo user (one account)	**Consumer access** only	Shows what a business user sees: dashboards and Genie Agents, no notebooks or compute.

Sign-in is through SSO (Microsoft Entra ID). **No groups need to be created.** The setup shares the dashboards, Genie Agents and lab workbook with the workspace's built-in `users` group, which is everyone in the workspace, and recognises facilitators by email. To share with an existing group instead, set `share_with` in `00_master_setup`.

3.6 Unity Catalog objects

The setup notebook creates these objects. Creating a catalog needs the `CREATE CATALOG` privilege, and on metastores without root storage a managed location: set it in the setup, or create `smbc_workshop` yourself in Catalog Explorer, which can use Default Storage. If the catalog already exists, whoever runs the setup needs `ALL PRIVILEGES` and `MANAGE` on it.

Object	Contents	What attendees need
Catalog `smbc_workshop`	Everything below, tagged `synthetic_data = true` and `workshop_date` (any tag a governed tag policy rejects is skipped)	`USE CATALOG`, and `CREATE SCHEMA` for their own schema
Volume `smbc_workshop.raw.landing`	Raw source extracts and the limits spreadsheet	`READ VOLUME`
Volume `smbc_workshop.raw.facilitator`	Answer key	Nothing
Schema `smbc_workshop.checkpoint`	Save-point tables (Lab 1 reference solution)	`USE SCHEMA`, `SELECT`
Schema `smbc_workshop.ops`	Check-in and lab-answer tables	`USE SCHEMA`, `MODIFY`
One schema per attendee, e.g. `smbc_workshop.jane_tan`	Each person's Lab 1 output; their check-in block creates it	They own it

Giving attendees access. The setup grants attendees nothing. Once it has run, the catalog owner or a metastore admin runs these three statements. `account users` is everyone in the account; use an existing group instead if you prefer.

```
GRANT USE CATALOG, USE SCHEMA, SELECT, CREATE SCHEMA ON CATALOG smbc_workshop TO `account users`;
GRANT READ VOLUME ON VOLUME smbc_workshop.raw.landing TO `account users`;
GRANT MODIFY ON SCHEMA smbc_workshop.ops TO `account users`;
```

Granting `READ VOLUME` on the landing volume only keeps the answer key private. Attendees need no privileges on the governance demo's functions, because row filters and column masks run with their owner's rights. `07_check_requirements` reports whether attendees have everything they need.

3.7 Network and devices

- SMBC laptops on the venue network can open the workspace URL and sign in with SSO. If the workspace uses **IP access lists** or **Private Link**, allow the venue's egress addresses.
- Proxies and SSL inspection allow the workspace URL and `*.azuredatabricks.net`, including websockets.
- Use a current version of Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome.
- The quiz and the polls run on phones (Slido), so nothing needs installing on laptops.

3.8 Smoke tests

Run these as a **test attendee** (not an admin), **on an SMBC laptop, on the SMBC network**, after the setup notebooks have run and `07_check_requirements` passes.

#	Test	Expected result	Proves
1	Sign in through SSO; open the SQL editor on the workshop's SQL warehouse; run the check-in block (A.1)	It shows your schema, e.g. `smbc_workshop.jane_tan`	Access, entitlements, warehouse, catalog access
2	**+ New** → **Visual data prep**; add a Source from `smbc_workshop.raw.landing/facilities`	Rows preview	Designer, serverless, volume grant

#	Test	Expected result	Proves
3	In Designer, type a Genie Code prompt: "*Trim and upper-case the currency column*"	A Prepare operator appears on the canvas	Partner-powered AI, cross-Geo (Genie Code agentic)
4	Add an **Output** to your own schema and **Run**; click **Schedule**	Table written; a job created	Schema grants, Jobs
5	Drag `group_limits.xlsx` (downloaded from the landing volume) onto the canvas	A Source operator for the spreadsheet	Excel file support
6	**+ New** → **Dashboard**; add `smbc_workshop.checkpoint.gold_group_exposure`; ask the AI assistant for a bar chart; **Publish**	Chart created; dashboard published	AI/BI, AI-assisted charts
7	**Genie Agents** → **New** on the two checkpoint gold tables; ask "*Top 5 groups by exposure at the latest month end*", then try **Agent mode**	Answer with SQL; agent-mode report	Genie Agents (chat and agent mode)
8	Open `<workspace URL>/one` and use chat	Genie One loads; chat answers	Genie One chat
9	In a notebook, ask Genie Code to "*profile smbc_workshop.checkpoint.gold_group_exposure*"	It plans, runs code, summarises	Genie Code agent mode
10	In Catalog Explorer, open a table → AI-suggested description; open the **Lineage** tab	Suggestion shown; lineage graph	AI-generated comments, lineage
11	Sign in as the **Consumer access** user	Lands in Genie One; sees shared dashboard and Genie Agent	Consumer experience

3.9 What processes data where

From the Designated Services page (updated 14 October 2026) and the Partner-powered AI features page:

Feature used in the workshop	Model provider	Asia Pacific Geo (e.g. Singapore)	Japan Geo
Genie Agents: chat mode	Azure OpenAI service	Needs cross-Geo processing	In-Geo
Genie Agents: agent mode	Anthropic on Databricks	Needs cross-Geo processing	In-Geo
Chat in Genie One	Anthropic on Databricks	Needs cross-Geo processing	In-Geo
Genie Code: agentic capabilities (also used by Designer)	Azure OpenAI service and Anthropic on Databricks	Needs cross-Geo processing	In-Geo
Genie Code: chat and cell actions	Azure OpenAI service	In-Geo	In-Geo
AI/BI dashboards	Azure OpenAI service	In-Geo	In-Geo
AI-generated comments	Azure OpenAI service (Databricks-hosted if partner features are off)	In-Geo	In-Geo

Points the documentation makes that risk and technology reviewers usually ask about:

- **Storage stays in the Geo.** "*Your data is not stored outside of your workspace's Geo regardless of this setting.*"
- **Anthropic on Databricks** "*uses endpoints hosted by Databricks within the Databricks security perimeter.*"
- **Genie Agents query data as the person asking.** Generated queries are read-only, data access is evaluated with each user's own Unity Catalog permissions, and row filters and column masks are enforced per user. A

question about data a user can't access returns an empty response.

- **What Genie Code sends to the model:** the prompt plus relevant context, such as table and column names, descriptions, the code being worked on, data samples and cell outputs, all within the user's Unity Catalog permissions. By default an AI classifier approves actions that carry out the request and blocks actions beyond it; users can instead approve every action themselves.
- **Cost:** Genie One and Genie Agents usage by users is free until 31 January 2027 (service principals are billed). Genie Code has been pay-as-you-go since 8 July 2026, with a free monthly allowance per user. Account admins can set budgets and cost controls for Genie.